furtherance of the common cause leaves some leeway for the leadership of the group. As long as they act to promote the cause which justified bringing the group together, the individual cannot withdraw his financial support merely because he disagrees with the group's strategy. If that were allowed, we would be reversing the *Hanson* case, *sub silentio*." *Machinists* v. *Street*, 367 U. S., at 778 (Douglas, J., concurring).

B

The National Labor Relations Act leaves regulation of the labor relations of state and local governments to the States. See 29 U. S. C. § 152 (2). Michigan has chosen to establish for local government units a regulatory scheme which, although not identical in every respect to the NLRA or the Railway Labor Act,[17] is broadly modeled after federal law. *E. g.*, *Rockwell* v. *Crestwood School Dist. Bd. of Ed.*, 393 Mich. 616, 635–636, 227 N. W. 2d 736, 744–745, appeal dismissed *sub nom. Crestwood Ed. Assn.* v. *Board of Ed. of Crestwood*, 427 U. S. 901; *Detroit Police Officers Assn.* v. *Detroit*, 391 Mich. 44, 53, 214 N. W. 2d 803, 807–808; *Michigan Employment Relations Comm'n* v. *Reeths-Puffer School Dist.*, 391 Mich. 253, 260, and n. 11, 215 N. W. 2d 672, 675, and n. 11. Under Michigan law employees of local government units enjoy rights parallel to those protected under federal legislation: the rights to self-organization and to bargain collectively, Mich. Comp. Laws §§ 423.209, 423.215 (1970); see 29 U. S. C. § 157; 45 U. S. C. § 152 Fourth; and the right to secret-ballot representation elections, Mich. Comp. Laws § 423.212 (1970); see 29 U. S. C. § 159 (e)(1); 45 U. S. C. § 152 Ninth.

Several aspects of Michigan law that mirror provisions of the Railway Labor Act are of particular importance here. A union that obtains the support of a majority of employees

[17] See, *e. g.*, *infra*, at 229.